



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

īrṣyāpaṇḍādayo ye 'nye catvāraḥ samudāhṛtāḥ | 12.015a
santyaktavyāḥ patitavat kṣatayonyā api striyāḥ || 15 || 12.015c
ākṣiptamoghabijābhyām patyāv apratikarmaṇi | 12.016a
patir anyah smṛto nāryā vatsaram sampratīkṣya tu || 16 || 12.016c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 12, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The verses before us from the Nāradaśmṛiti delve into the intricate realm of marital relationships, offering guidance on navigating challenges and upholding dharma, particularly for women. We see the text addressing situations of abandonment and barrenness within marriage, shedding light on the social and spiritual considerations of the time. The first verse stresses that certain negative qualities – envy, deceit, and others not explicitly named here but understood as detrimental to the marriage – should be abandoned by a wife, much like one would avoid someone who has fallen from grace (patita). The text emphasizes the importance of a woman maintaining her spiritual purity and ethical conduct even in the face of hardship. It's a call to cultivate inner strength and righteousness, understanding that your actions directly impact your spiritual journey.

The following verse deals with more specific grounds for a woman to consider seeking another partner. It outlines situations where the husband is impotent (producing "moghabija," infertile seed) or has been abusive ("akṣipta"), and provides no redress. In such circumstances, the Nāradaśmṛiti allows the wife to wait one year before considering another marriage. This waiting period provides time for reconciliation, reflection, and perhaps societal intervention. But more importantly, it underscores that marriage is intended to be a mutually supportive union, not a source of suffering or spiritual stagnation.

In contemporary life, while the social context differs, the underlying principles remain relevant. While divorce is now a legal option, the spiritual wisdom encourages you to first examine your own conduct and character. Are you nurturing the relationship with kindness, understanding, and forgiveness? Secondly, it highlights the importance of healthy boundaries and self-respect. No one should endure abuse or neglect. The text urges you to seek healthy relationships where both partners contribute to mutual growth and well-being, both materially and spiritually. This passage is not simply about legal loopholes, but about dharma, spiritual growth, and finding a path that aligns with your highest self.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you nurturing the relationships in your life with the intention of mutual growth and spiritual well-being, and what steps can you take today to embody these principles?